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General Comment

The debate around AI and its influence on everything from individual livelihoods to whole career field is extensive. However, it should be universally accepted that utilizing copyrighted work without consent of the creator for commercial work is not acceptable. Directly or indirectly, allowing companies to train their AI models off of the products of individuals who have not given reasonable consent for such use, opens doors that must be recognized. Just as many of these cases, it sets a precedent that copyright holds no value, that private cooperations may use and exploit private products and individuals creations for commercial use without worry. It begins with training AI, however if AI may utilize and, indirectly, copy the material- what stops the companies in question from attempting to more directly steal with the same logic? Be it a program stealing the material or a human, theft is theft. AI should not be demonized as an evolving and useful tool to be utilized by many fields- but progress should not blind from the reality of the blatant and unapologetic theft. AI should face the same restrictions applied to all, and as such held to the standard that only material the user has gained proper reasonable permission to utilize may be used for commercial purposes- such as training an AI that can and will be used, commercially.